I did so. Seconds later, I heard him say, "See what I've got for you."

On opening my eyes, I saw a big brown box. On it was written:

"WITH THE BEST COMPLIMENTS OF CAPT. LINDSAY."

I took the box and eagerly opened it. "Oh, what a lovely ship!" I exclaimed. "Does this really belong to me? Can I keep it?"

Lying snugly on a velvet backing was a most beautiful model of the ship. On it was inscribed "B.I.S.N. & Co. S.S. RAJULA." I placed the box carefully on the table. Then I threw my hands round the captain and hugged and kissed him.

He patted my cheek and smiled as he saw me lift the box and walk happily out of his room. I proudly showed my present to everyone I met. "See what the Captain has given me. Isn't it lovely?"

"Yes, indeed," was the unanimous verdict.

I was the happiest person on board that day.

Vasantha Murthi

READ AND UNDERSTAND

A. Complete the following statements.

1. Everyone in the ship started to pray because ----------.
2. Vasantha's imagination run wild because ----------.
3. Vasantha made a lot of noise because ----------.
4. Vasantha could not see the rescue operation because ----------.
5. The captain presented a gift to Vasantha because ----------.

B. Identify the speaker / character.

1. Don't worry, Madam, it's only a warning.
2. A man fell into the sea. Please save him.
3. Stop ship. Drop anchor. Quick!
4. He'll have to be given artificial respiration and kept warm.
5. Wake up, child.

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